sit in the waiting room. As we waited, Papaji tried to divert my attention by talking about random subjects, but I only nodded absentmindedly. After half an hour, I was finally called to the commandant's office.

'May I come in, Sir?' I asked.

'Please,' replied the commandant, an air force officer who sat behind a big walnut-wood table dressed in his decorated uniform. 'Have a seat.' He took off his cap and continued. 'So the good news for you is that the board has cleared your TR for weight. Well done.'

'Thank you, Sir,' I replied.

'But you're one centimetre short of the minimum height required for flying.' My face drooped and I stared at the floor.

'However,' he continued, and I listened without looking up, 'as per the anthropometry tests, your arm reach and leg length have been found to be one centimetre more than the minimum required.' At this, I looked up at him. 'And so I have decided to waive off the one centimetre and recommend you for flying.'

I could not believe my ears. What had just happened?

'I think you were born to be a pilot,' he said, and continued to give me further directions on the documentation and more. But a strange silence had fallen over me. When I came out of his office, there was a wide smile on my face. Papaji immediately understood what must have happened. I ran to hug him.

'You did it, Papaji,' I exclaimed.

'We did it,' he replied. 'Now let's go to the cafeteria. I've ordered something for us to celebrate.'

'What?' I asked.

'Cassata,' he replied.